

E008

Technology Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

The CFO's assistant reports that the third-floor printer, a new color model leased last spring, will not print. The technician has gathered details, confirmed the problem, and formed a theory that the print queue is stuck. What is the next step?

- A. Document the findings and lessons learned.
- B. Test the theory to confirm the cause.
- C. Implement the fix by clearing the queue and closing the ticket.
- D. Request a replacement printer under the lease.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A technician restarts a stuck service, and the user confirms the application works again. What should the technician do next?

- A. Verify full system function, add any preventive measures, then document the issue and fix.
- B. Close the ticket immediately.
- C. Go back and form a new theory of the cause.
- D. Skip documentation, since simple fixes never need it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Two tickets arrive. The first, sent at 8:02 a.m., says a vice president's wireless mouse stopped working; the VP is presenting to the board next week. The second, sent at 8:05 a.m., says the order-entry system is down for all 40 sales reps during a sales promotion. Which ticket should be worked first?

- A. The VP's mouse, because of the upcoming board presentation.
- B. The order-entry outage.
- C. The VP's mouse, because it arrived first.
- D. Both are equal, because every ticket is equally important.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

On an impact-by-urgency matrix, an issue affects only one user (low impact) but will cause that user to miss a deadline in one hour (high urgency). What priority fits best?

- A.** The highest priority, because it is urgent.
- B.** It cannot be rated, because single-user issues are never prioritized.
- C.** The lowest priority, because only one person is affected.
- D.** A middle priority — urgency raises it, but low impact keeps it below a major outage.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

The same VPN disconnect has happened 15 times this month. Each time, the help desk, which averages a four-minute response time, restarts the gateway and service returns. The manager wants the disconnects to stop for good. Which process fits?

- A.** Change management.
- B.** Keep restarting, since service always comes back.
- C.** Problem management.
- D.** Incident management.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A payment system is down. The team's goal is to get customers paying again as fast as possible, even with a temporary workaround. Which process fits?

- A.** Release management.
- B.** Change management.
- C.** Problem management.
- D.** Incident management.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A web app is slow. The server is three years old and has 32 GB of RAM. A technician adds more RAM, updates a network driver, and rebuilds a database index at the same time. The app is now faster. What is the main weakness of this approach?

- A. No one can tell which change fixed the problem.
- B. The RAM was surely the fix, since the server is old.
- C. There is no weakness; the app is faster.
- D. Driver updates always fix slowness, so the others were wasted.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

The chief operating officer, who holds an MBA from a well-known school, asks what happened during this morning's outage. The root cause was a failed storage-controller firmware update. How should the IT manager open the briefing?

- A. "Customers could not place orders for two hours; service is restored, and we are fixing the cause so it does not repeat."
- B. Use technical terms freely, since the COO has an MBA.
- C. A detailed walk-through of the firmware update and controller logs.
- D. Say nothing until the root cause is fully documented.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A system runs on hardware from two vendors. In a 30-day month (720 hours), it had 4 outages totaling 6 hours. What was its availability?

- A. About 99.44%
- B. About 99.17%
- C. 1.5 hours
- D. About 0.83%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An SLA requires 99.9% availability over a 30-day month (720 hours). What is the most downtime allowed?

- A.** 7.2 hours
- B.** 719.28 hours
- C.** About 43 minutes (0.72 hours)
- D.** Zero; an SLA never allows any downtime.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An IT manager wants to introduce a new ticketing process. The team of 14, most with more than ten years of tenure, resists because “the old way works.” The new tool has a sleek dashboard. What is the most effective way to shift the culture?

- A.** Send a memo mandating the process by a firm deadline.
- B.** Replace resistant staff, since culture cannot change otherwise.
- C.** Win them over by demonstrating the sleek dashboard.
- D.** Involve respected team members early as champions and explain how the change helps the team.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An outage happened during the quarterly sales push after a first-year engineer pushed a misconfigured change. Service is restored. What should the post-incident review focus on?

- A.** Freeze all changes permanently.
- B.** Skip the review, since service is back.
- C.** What process gaps let the change through, such as missing peer review, and which actions will close them.
- D.** Who was at fault and what discipline applies.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

The CFO's assistant reports that the third-floor printer, ~~a new color model leased last spring~~, will not print. The technician has gathered details, confirmed the problem, and formed a theory that the print queue is stuck. What is the next step?

Target word: next troubleshooting step **Decides:** A theory exists but has not been tested.

A	Inverted operation	Documentation is the last step, not the next one.
B	Correct	Testing comes right after forming a theory.
C	Dropped element	Skips testing the theory and verifying the result.
D	Camouflage	The lease detail does not decide the troubleshooting step.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A technician restarts a stuck service, and the user confirms the application works again. What should the technician do next?

Target word: steps after the fix **Decides:** The fix is in; verification and documentation remain.

A	Correct	The method ends with verification and documentation.
B	Dropped element	Drops full verification and documentation.
C	Inverted operation	That is only needed if the fix fails.
D	Absolute language	Documenting simple fixes helps the next person solve them faster.

3. Answer B Concept 2

Two tickets arrive. The first, ~~sent at 8:02 a.m.~~, says a vice president's wireless mouse stopped working; ~~the VP is presenting to the board next week~~. The second, ~~sent at 8:05 a.m.~~, says the order-entry system is down for all 40 sales reps during a sales promotion. Which ticket should be worked first?

Target word: which ticket first **Decides:** High impact (40 reps, revenue) and high urgency (live promotion).

A	Camouflage	The presentation is next week; it adds no urgency today.
B	Correct	It has the highest impact and urgency.
C	Confusion set	Arrival order is not a priority rule.
D	Absolute language	Priority exists precisely because tickets differ in impact and urgency.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

On an impact-by-urgency matrix, an issue affects only one user (low impact) but will cause that user to miss a deadline in one hour (high urgency). What priority fits best?

Target word: combine low impact and high urgency **Decides:** Both dimensions count.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the low impact.
B	Absolute language	Every ticket gets a priority.
C	Confusion set	Ignores the high urgency.
D	Correct	Priority combines both factors.

5. Answer C Concept 3

The same VPN disconnect has happened 15 times this month. Each time, the help desk, ~~which averages a four-minute response time,~~ restarts the gateway and service returns. The manager wants the disconnects to stop for good. Which process fits?

Target word: process for repeated failures **Decides:** The goal is to remove the cause, not restore service.

A	Adjacent category	Change management controls the fix once the cause is known.
B	Absolute language	Workarounds do not remove the cause.
C	Correct	It investigates the root cause of repeat incidents.
D	Confusion set	That is the restart work already being done.

6. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A payment system is down. The team's goal is to get customers paying again as fast as possible, even with a temporary workaround. Which process fits?

Target word: restore-service process — reverse of the root-cause item **Decides:** Speed of restoration is the goal.

A	Confusion set	It packages and deploys new versions.
B	Adjacent category	It governs planned changes, not the first response.
C	Inverted operation	Root-cause work comes after service is restored.
D	Correct	It restores normal service quickly.

7. Answer A Concept 4

A web app is slow. ~~The server is three years old and has 32 GB of RAM.~~ A technician adds more RAM, updates a network driver, and rebuilds a database index at the same time. The app is now faster. What is the main weakness of this approach?

Target word: flaw in the method **Decides:** Three changes at once.

A	Correct	Changing one variable at a time isolates the cause.
B	Camouflage	Server age does not show which change helped.
C	Dropped element	Drops the need to know the cause for next time.
D	Absolute language	No single fix always works.

8. Answer A Concept 5

The chief operating officer, ~~who holds an MBA from a well-known school,~~ asks what happened during this morning's outage. The root cause was a failed storage-controller firmware update. How should the IT manager open the briefing?

Target word: message for an executive **Decides:** The audience is nontechnical.

A	Correct	Leads with business impact, status, and next steps.
B	Camouflage	A business degree does not make storage details meaningful.
C	Adjacent category	Right for engineers, not for an executive.
D	Inverted operation	Leaders need timely updates, even partial ones.

9. Answer B Concept 6

~~A system runs on hardware from two vendors.~~ In a 30-day month (720 hours), it had 4 outages totaling 6 hours. What was its availability?

Target word: availability percentage **Decides:** Uptime = $720 - 6 = 714$ hours.

A	Wrong stem number	Subtracts the 4 outages as if they were hours.
B	Correct	$714 / 720 \approx 99.17\%$.
C	Adjacent category	That is mean time to repair (6 / 4), not availability.
D	Inverted operation	That is the downtime share, not availability.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

An SLA requires 99.9% availability over a 30-day month (720 hours). What is the most downtime allowed?

Target word: solve for allowed downtime **Decides:** 0.1% of 720 hours.

A	Confusion set	That is the 99% allowance, one decimal place off.
B	Inverted operation	That is the required uptime.
C	Correct	$720 \times 0.001 = 0.72 \text{ h} \approx 43.2 \text{ min.}$
D	Absolute language	A 99.9% target explicitly allows 0.1% downtime.

11. Answer D Concept 7

An IT manager wants to introduce a new ticketing process. The team of 14, most with more than ten years of tenure, resists because “the old way works.” ~~The new tool has a sleek dashboard.~~ What is the most effective way to shift the culture?

Target word: culture-change approach **Decides:** Resistance comes from not seeing the benefit.

A	Inverted operation	Mandates can win compliance but often deepen resistance.
B	Absolute language	Culture can shift through involvement and leadership.
C	Camouflage	Visual appeal does not address why the team resists.
D	Correct	Insider involvement and a clear why build buy-in.

12. Answer C Concept 8

~~An outage happened during the quarterly sales push~~ after a ~~first-year~~ engineer pushed a misconfigured change. Service is restored. What should the post-incident review focus on?

Target word: focus of the review **Decides:** A single change reached production unchecked.

A	Absolute language	Blocking every change stops needed improvements.
B	Dropped element	Drops the learning step that prevents a repeat.
C	Correct	Blameless reviews fix the system that allowed the error.
D	Inverted operation	Blame discourages reporting and leaves the gap open.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	8	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Troubleshooting method order	Identify the problem, form a theory, test it, plan and implement the fix, verify full function, then document.	Jumping from a theory straight to a fix, or skipping verification and documentation.	“What is the next step?” after a theory is formed or a fix is applied.
2	Priority = impact × urgency	Priority comes from how many people or how much business is affected and how fast harm grows, not from who reported it or when.	Working tickets by rank of the requester or arrival order.	Two tickets side by side, one from a senior person.
3	Incident vs. problem management	Incident management restores service fast, even with a workaround; problem management finds and removes the root cause of repeat incidents.	Treating repeated quick fixes as solving the problem.	The same failure recurring many times.
4	Change one variable at a time	Test one change, observe, then try the next, so you know what fixed the issue.	Applying several fixes at once and calling it solved.	Multiple changes made together before a result.
5	Communicating with nontechnical stakeholders	Lead with business impact, current status, and next steps in plain language; keep technical detail for technical audiences.	Opening with the technical root cause or staying silent until everything is known.	An executive or business audience asking what happened.
6	Availability and downtime math	Availability = uptime / total time; allowed downtime = $(1 - \text{target}) \times \text{total time}$.	Reporting the downtime share as availability, or confusing counts with hours.	Hours of outage in a month and a percentage target.
7	Influencing organizational culture	Culture shifts when respected insiders are involved early and people understand why the change helps them.	Relying on mandates or flashy features to win people over.	A team that resists a new process because “the old way works.”
8	Blameless post-incident review	Reviews look for the process and system gaps that allowed a failure and assign improvement actions, not blame.	Finding the person at fault and stopping there.	An outage traced to one person’s action.

Course scope (public description): Technology Management provides learners with the knowledge and skills needed to manage and troubleshoot technology systems within an organization. This course will enable students to diagnose, prioritize, and resolve technical issues. The course also emphasizes the importance of collaboration and communication within teams to support a cohesive organizational culture. By the end of the course, students will be equipped to identify and address technology issues, communicate effectively with both technical and nontechnical stakeholders, and work within and influence the organizational culture to support technology management initiatives. There are no prerequisites for this course.